

THE RUBBER BAND MODEL

HOW TO DEAL WITH A DILEMMA

Is this a situation you are familiar with? A friend, colleague or client needs to make a decision that could irrevocably alter their future: for example to change career, move to another city or take early retirement. The arguments for and against are evenly balanced. How can you help them out of their dilemma?

Copy out the rubber band model, and ask the person to ask themselves: What is holding me? What is pulling me?

At first glance the method seems to be a simple variation of the conventional question 'What are the pros and cons?' The difference is that 'What is holding me?' and 'What is pulling me?' are positive questions and reflect a situation with two attractive alternatives.

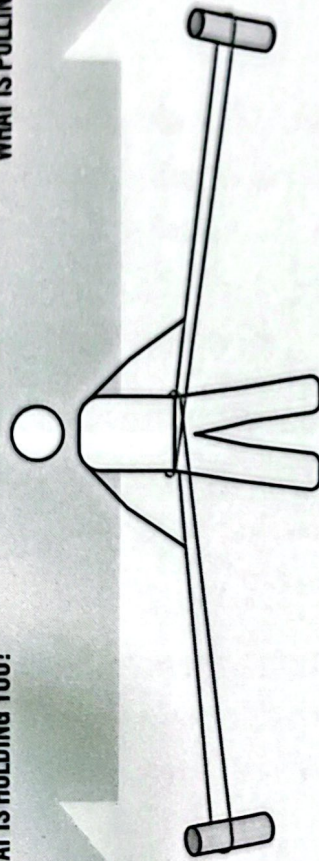
A peacefulness follows any decision, even the wrong one.

Rita Mae Brown

➡ See also: SWOT analysis (p. 12)

WHAT IS PULLING YOU?

WHAT IS HOLDING YOU?



If you have to decide between two good options, ask yourself what is holding you, and what is pulling you.